

Enter the name of the variable followed by a dot, and then the method `removeprefix()`. Inside the parentheses, enter the prefix you want to remove from the original string.

Like the methods for removing whitespace, `removeprefix()` leaves the original string unchanged. If you want to keep the new value with the prefix removed, either reassign it to the original variable or assign it to a new variable:

```
>>> simple_url = nostarch_url.removeprefix('https://')
```

When you see a URL in an address bar and the `https://` part isn't shown, the browser is probably using a method like `removeprefix()` behind the scenes.

Avoiding Syntax Errors with Strings

One kind of error that you might see with some regularity is a syntax error. A *syntax error* occurs when Python doesn't recognize a section of your program as valid Python code. For example, if you use an apostrophe within single quotes, you'll produce an error. This happens because Python interprets everything between the first single quote and the apostrophe as a string. It then tries to interpret the rest of the text as Python code, which causes errors.

Here's how to use single and double quotes correctly. Save this program as *apostrophe.py* and then run it:

```
apostrophe.py message = "One of Python's strengths is its diverse community."  
print(message)
```

The apostrophe appears inside a set of double quotes, so the Python interpreter has no trouble reading the string correctly:

```
One of Python's strengths is its diverse community.
```

However, if you use single quotes, Python can't identify where the string should end:

```
message = 'One of Python's strengths is its diverse community.'  
print(message)
```

You'll see the following output:

```
File "apostrophe.py", line 1  
  message = 'One of Python's strengths is its diverse community.'  
                                     ❶ ^  
SyntaxError: unterminated string literal (detected at line 1)
```

In the output you can see that the error occurs right after the final single quote ❶. This syntax error indicates that the interpreter doesn't recognize